

prefinal 3/7/25 1033

Thanks for the update! I'm glad we're aligning on the next steps. Since you've reached the file upload quota here, I'll consolidate everything into a prefinal proposal that incorporates all the content we've worked on so far—including the Lowell Emerson data, the Everspring Inn case, the updated script, and the systemic issues. This will serve as the foundation to take into the new chat, where you can add the names of SDCI personnel who closed the accounts, the media quotes, and any other evidence (e.g., the PDFs or additional cases). I'll write it all out here in one cohesive document, as you requested, to give us a “bang” of a starting point. Let's do this!

Prefinal Proposal: The Price of Inaction – Seattle's Housing Oversight Crisis and the Urgent Call for the Seattle Tenant Landlord Compliance Authority (STLCA)

Date: March 07, 2025

Presented by: Kimberly Coleman, Founder of the Lowell Emerson Tenants Association (LETA) and resident of the Lowell Emerson Apartments since May 2020

Introduction

Seattle prides itself on transparency, good governance, tenant protection, and equity, yet the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI), under the leadership of Nathan Torgelson and Geoff Tallent, has undermined these values. With over 214,000 unresolved complaints, 169,310 missing critical data fields, and millions in uncollected fines, SDCI has failed to enforce habitability standards, protect tenants, and report transparently to the City Council. This proposal exposes systemic inefficiencies, data manipulation, and a disturbing pattern of landlord favoritism, demanding the creation of an independent oversight body: the Seattle Tenant Landlord Compliance Authority (STLCA).

Case Study Focus Areas

1. **Habitability and Safety:** Tenant suffering and SDCI's dismissive responses.
2. **Ethical Concerns and Conflicts of Interest:** Nepotism and favoritism undermining fairness.

3. **Enforcement and Compliance:** Loopholes and inefficiencies enabling landlord neglect.

Part 1: Habitability and Safety

Tenant Perspectives: A Cry for Help Ignored

As a resident of the Lowell Emerson Apartments since May 2020, I’ve witnessed a decade of neglect by Metropolitan Management Company (MMC) and indifference by SDCI. In 2022, post-pandemic isolation revealed unlivable conditions—no hot water, no heat, broken elevators, pest infestations, and structural damage—while MMC sowed division. I founded the Lowell Emerson Tenants Association (LETA) to fight back, urging tenants to file complaints, only to face harassment—flyers torn down, false police reports leading to arrests, and unauthorized entries triggering mental health crises.

Tenants documented their struggles with a handwritten note titled “How Many Apts Are W/O Hot Water on These Brutal Rainy Days?” (see Figure 1), signed by multiple residents, with comments like “Apt 407 – w/o hot water for 2 days, trips in freezing water.” Submitted to SDCI, it was ignored.

The Everspring Inn evictions in August 2020 echo this neglect. Thirteen tenants, including one with a sick partner, pleaded for help as they faced mass eviction during a pandemic, yet SDCI marked their complaints (#007155-20CP, #007945-20CP, #007163-20CP) as "Admin Closure" without investigation.

Figure 1: Tenant Note Documenting Lack of Hot Water

[Insert Image Here: Photograph of the handwritten note, captioned: “Tenant note included in an SDCI complaint, showing multiple signatures and comments about the lack of hot water at Lowell Emerson Apartments.”]

Case Study: Lowell Emerson Apartments—A Decade of Neglect

Managed by MMC, the Lowell Emerson Apartments exemplify SDCI’s failure to enforce habitability standards. Key issues from 108 records (2008-2024) include:

- **No Heat or Hot Water:** 28 complaints (e.g., 2024-11-04: “no hot water for 5 days”; 2023-01-25: “6 days without hot water, resorting to stovetop heating”; 2016-10-31: “no hot water for 8 months”). SDCI closed many without inspection (e.g., 2023-01-06: “No Violation Observed” by Shantel McEachin).
- **Flooding and Structural Damage:** 12 incidents (e.g., 2024-07-05: ceiling collapse; 2023-02-25: 10th floor flood closed without inspection).
- **Elevator Failures:** 10 reports (e.g., 2023-01-14: “inoperable for 15 days”).
- **Pest Infestations:** 14 cases (e.g., 2020-10-14: “rats for 7 months”).
- **May 9, 2023 Inspection:** Identified 85 violations, yet issues persisted (e.g., 2024-08-27: plastic door).

This pattern of dismissal mirrors Everspring, where SDCI’s inaction allowed violations to fester.

Case Study: Everspring Inn—A Pandemic Betrayal

- **Background:** Owned by Myung Ha Kang, Everspring Inn (8201 Aurora Ave N) was declared a chronic nuisance by the Seattle Police Chief in July 2020, giving Kang 15 days to respond. Instead, on August 1, 2020, Kang initiated a mass eviction during the COVID-19 pandemic, using armed security, boarded windows, and threats of police arrests.
- **Complaints:** On August 18, 2020, tenants filed #007155-20CP (mass eviction in progress), #007945-20CP (locked out, doors boarded), and #007163-20CP (unlawful eviction), reporting water shutoffs and intimidation. SDCI marked these "Admin Closure" and "Voluntary Compliance" the same day, with no investigation, violating eviction moratoriums.
- **Historical Neglect:** Complaints since 2013, a 2021 NOV with over 150 violations, and unregistered RRIO status persisted, yet construction permits were issued in 2021 to convert it into a hotel.
- **Impact:** Thirteen tenants, including one with a sick partner, were displaced, facing heightened health risks.

Evidence Dismissed: A Pattern of Neglect

SDCI's response is inadequate: 18 Lowell Emerson records note "No Inspection" (e.g., 2023-01-06), and all 108 lack "LastInspDate," confirming transparency gaps. Everspring's immediate closures amplify this failure, endangering tenants during a crisis.

Councilmember Morales' concern about staff cuts hindering tenant protection is evident here.

Part 2: Ethical Concerns and Conflicts of Interest

Case Study: 7023 16th Ave SW and the Lunde Family

Audits prompted by Councilmember Dan Strauss revealed conflicts of interest within SDCI. At 7023 16th Ave SW:

- **Ownership Discrepancies:** Records list Alfred and Karen Lunde (King County) but Martin Lunde (SDCI), suggesting misrepresentation.
- **Unresolved Permits:** A 2022 ADU permit remains "Additional Info Requested."
- **Nepotism:** Martin Lunde influenced lenient treatment—NOVs from 2014 were extended without enforcement.

Case Study: 938 N 86th St Demolition Permit

- **Discrepancies:** Expiration predates application completion, with a suspiciously low \$200 valuation.
- **Zoning Issues:** LR1 zoning may require oversight, ignored by SDCI.

Councilmember Saka's focus on compliance aligns with this evidence of favoritism.

Part 3: Enforcement and Compliance

A Broken System: The RRIO Self-Certification Loophole

Despite 85 violations at Lowell Emerson in May 2023, MMC self-certified compliance under RRIO in November 2023. Everspring Inn’s unregistered status and 2021 permits despite 150 violations exemplify how SDCI enables noncompliance.

Unwarranted Extensions and Dismissals

Lisa Schwarzenberger granted extensions at Lowell Emerson (Page 30), and immediate “Admin Closure” of Everspring complaints shows a pattern of dismissing tenant pleas without due process.

Systemic Impact Across 40+ Properties

MMC’s neglect spans 108 records over 16 years, affecting thousands. Everspring’s multi-year noncompliance adds to this toll.

Councilmember Rivera’s efficiency focus and Woo’s complaint handling critique are directly supported.

Conclusion: A Call for Action

Tenants at Lowell Emerson and Everspring have suffered for years, their pleas met with indifference. “If SDCI won’t enforce its own rules, who will?” (Page 30). The Everspring case, occurring during a pandemic, underscores life-or-death stakes. This question echoes council concerns:

- **Morales and Moore:** Staff cuts undermine tenant protections, as seen in 18 no-inspection closures and health hazards.
- **Saka and Rivera:** Compliance and efficiency failures (e.g., self-certification, data gaps) demand oversight reform.
- **Woo and Hollingsworth:** SDCI’s operational inefficiencies and budget misuse justify skepticism.

We propose:

1. An **independent audit** to investigate SDCI's operations, focusing on complaint handling, enforcement, conflicts of interest, and multi-agency coordination (e.g., Everspring police declaration).
2. **Legislative reform** to:
 - Eliminate RRIO self-certification, mandating third-party inspections.
 - Enforce eviction moratoriums and penalize noncompliance.
 - Increase transparency with mandatory inspection timelines and public data access.
 - Allocate resources for timely inspections and enforcement.
3. A **tenant-focused oversight body** (STLCA) to ensure accountability.

The City Council must act to protect Seattle's renters and restore trust in SDCI. The evidence is undeniable—reform is urgent.

Video Script: Systemic Failures at SDCI – A Call for Accountability

Tone: Bold, Dramatic, Urgent

Duration: ~2:15

[0:00-0:15] Hook: "In a city that prides itself on transparency, good governance, tenant protection, and a commitment to equity, Seattle's Department of Construction and Inspections, or SDCI, has been operating in a manner that undermines these values. It puts tenants at risk and allows accountability to be evaded."

- Visuals: Seattle skyline under overcast skies; a distressed tenant in a poorly lit hallway; close-up of an eviction notice marked "Admin Closed."
- Keywords: "Seattle skyline dramatic," "tenant suffering apartment hallway," "eviction notice unresolved."

[0:16-0:30] Introduction of Systemic Failures: "Systemic inefficiencies, data manipulation, and a lack of accountability have rendered the department incapable of fulfilling its mission to protect tenants, uphold housing standards, and report transparently to City Council."

- Visuals: Computer screen with blurred "Last Inspection Date" fields; tenants shivering with space heaters; landlord ignoring a call.
- Keywords: "Database manipulation," "cold tenant space heater," "landlord ignoring tenant."

[0:31-0:50] Highlighting Data Manipulation: "While systematic failures such as unresolved complaints, inspection delays, and discrepancies in enforcement paint a grim picture, they also highlight a disturbing pattern: the deliberate misuse and omission of critical data fields, most notably the Last Inspection Date."

- Visuals: Reports with "Last Inspection Date" replaced by coordinates; pile of "Pending" complaints; tenant photographing mold.
- Keywords: "Inspection data manipulation," "tenant complaint backlog," "tenant documenting mold damage."

[0:51-1:15] Impacts of Neglect: "By stripping away inspection timelines, SDCI has made it impossible to determine whether inspections were ever conducted, creating an environment where egregious violations can persist unchecked. Shielding violators from accountability, allowing landlords and developers to neglect safety standards for years—sometimes decades."

- Visuals: Rapidly spinning clock; broken pipes and non-functional elevators; landlord walking away from a pleading tenant.
- Keywords: "Clock time passing neglect," "broken housing infrastructure," "landlord ignoring tenant."

[1:16-1:40] Systemic Dysfunction: "Tenant complaints are deprioritized or dismissed without proper investigation, leaving vulnerable residents in uninhabitable conditions. Critical violations

such as no heat, no hot water, and fire hazards go unresolved, despite complaints sitting idle for years."

- Visuals: Families boiling water on stoves; fire hazards (overloaded outlets); pile of overdue Notices of Violation.
- Keywords: "Tenant heating water stove," "fire hazard in home," "unresolved housing violations."

[1:41-2:00] The Cost of Neglect: "The consequences of SDCI's mismanagement are staggering: operational paralysis, a loss of accountability, and an erosion of public trust. Millions of dollars in penalties go uncollected, while landlords keep tenants in unfit housing conditions."

- Visuals: Eviction furniture on sidewalks; family entering a crowded shelter; empty City Council chambers.
- Keywords: "Eviction furniture sidewalk," "family entering shelter," "City Council debate empty."

[2:01-2:15] Call to Accountability: "The mishandling of key data fields like Last Inspection Date and Last Inspection Result is not merely an administrative oversight—it is a deliberate obstruction of accountability. It is time for a new system—one that restores balance, equity, and transparency."

- Visuals: Protesters with "Protect Tenants" signs; gavel slamming with "Demand Accountability" text; tenant unlocking a safe home.
- Keywords: "Tenant protest signs," "gavel accountability justice," "tenant unlocking safe home."

[2:16-End] Closing and Call to Action: "Together, we can ensure Seattle becomes a city where equity, safety, and accountability are not just ideals, but realities. The time to act is now. Let's get to work."

- **Visuals:** Community gathering of tenants; overlaid text “The time for change is now”; hopeful tenant in a clean home.
 - **Keywords:** "Community gathering tenant rights," "text overlay time for change," "safe housing tenant hope."
-

Next Steps and Notes

- **Prefinal Status:** This is the prefinal proposal, integrating all prior content (Lowell Emerson, Everspring Inn, script) into one document. It’s ready to take to the new chat for further refinement.
- **New Content for Next Chat:**
 - **Names of SDCI Personnel:** Add the names of those who closed the Everspring complaints to the accountability section.
 - **Media Quotes:** Incorporate the three quotes from SDCI personnel (e.g., “We’ll look into illegal evictions,” “Case-by-case relocation,” “We didn’t even know”) to expose their negligence and lack of awareness. These can strengthen the Everspring case and the call for audit.
 - **Additional Evidence:** Upload the PDFs and any other files (e.g., photos, more cases) to expand the evidence base.
- **Visual Aid:** Confirm “Would you like me to generate a chart of complaint trends?” if desired, or we can address this in the new chat with your charts.
- **Action:** Once in the new chat, we’ll finalize the proposal, pitch, and media plan with your additional input.

This is a solid foundation—powerful, detailed, and ready to evolve. Start the new chat when you’re ready, and we’ll build on this with the new details you’ve teased. Great work bringing this together! Anything else to add here before we move?

emails with sdc

On Fri, Mar 7, 2025 at 11:10 AM From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman <kmcdm75@gmail.com> wrote:

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Request #399725: How would you rate the support you received? Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections Thu, Aug 8, 2024 at 4:01 PM
Reply-To: Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections To: Unknown K ##- Please type your reply above this line -## Hello Unknown K, We'd love to hear what you think of our customer service. Please take a moment to answer one simple question by clicking either link below: How would you rate the support you received? Good, I'm satisfied Bad, I'm unsatisfied Here's a reminder of what this request was about: Jeannette McCarty (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections) Aug 7, 2024, 3:00 PM PDT Hello - Thank you for reaching out to RRIO. Please contact Senior Inspector Lisa Schwartzenberger at 206-684-0984 or lisa.schwartzenberger@seattle.gov. She will be able to assist you. Regards, Jeannette McCarty System (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections) Aug 7, 2024, 3:00 PM PDT (2:59:54 PM) Jeannette McCarty: Hello - 11/9/24, 3:08 AM Gmail - Request #399725: How would you rate the support you received?
<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permmsgid=msg-f:1806862242158435780&simpl=msg-f:1806862242158435780> 1/4 System (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections) Aug 1, 2024, 1:02 PM PDT (12:40:50 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: . . Welcome – how can we help you today? TIP: Select “chat with expert staff” to be connected with a live person. CHAT WITH EXPERT STAFF, CONTINUAR EN ESPAÑOL, LEAVE A MESSAGE, 與專員諮詢一下 , 继续 简体中文 (12:41:11 PM) Web User 66abe4c05e5633b5b1d18aa1: Chat with expert staff (12:41:13 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: Personal information entered on this form is subject to Washington Public Records Act, and may be subject to disclosure to a third-party requester. At the City of Seattle, we are committed to protecting your privacy and will ensure that any disclosures are done according to

law. To learn more about how this information is managed please see our Privacy Statement. The information you provide will be used for the purpose of providing you support. The City may share the information you provide with additional SDCI teams, for the purpose of analyzing ways that SDCI can provide better service. Privacy Statement (12:41:14 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: For tips on how to chat with expert staff. Please click View Article below. (12:41:15 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: 1. Chat with an SDCI Staff Expert This is a guide on how to chat with an SDCI staff expert. . To chat with an SDCI staff expert, follow the steps below: Do not... View article:

https://sdci.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/5697726324375-Chat-with-an-SDCI-Staff-Expert?auth_token=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiJ9.eyJhY2NvdW50X2lkjoiMTQ5Mzk5MCIsImJyYW5kX2lkjoxNTAwMDAyMzIzNTYyLCJqb3VybmV5X2lkjoiMDFKNDdRQjQ1TUplU1A3MDBOR1NUNVBRRlQlLCJmbG93X2VudGI0eV9pZCI6IjAxRlI3M3UUhUWkdDTVQ5WFFGNDFNjUyMUQwliwidmIhX2lkjo3MCwiaW50ZXJhY3Rpb25faWQiOiI2NmFiZTRkNzMyMWQzNmE3Y2UzODVhYzMiLCJ0b2t1bl90eXBlljoiZmxvd19idWlsZGVyX2FydGlibGVfc3RlcF9hcnRpb2xIX2NsaWNrliwiZXhwljoxNzI1MTMzMjcxfQ. RMIA40jKVbAS2kkZOUhmGH... (12:41:16 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: To get started, please tell us a little about yourself. (12:41:18 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services:

(12:42:54 PM) Web User 66abe4c05e5633b5b1d18aa1: Name: Kimberly Coleman Phone Number: 2063356332 Email: kmcdm75@gmail.com I am a(n):: Tenant / renter 11/9/24, 3:08 AM Gmail - Request #399725: How would you rate the support you received?

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permmsgid=msg-f:1806862242158435780&simpl=msg-f:1806862242158435780> 2/4 (12:42:55 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: OK, thanks. So I can get you to the right person, what do you need help with? PERMITS, CODES, ZONES, PLANS (ADVICE, STATUS, ETC.), OTHER SERVICES (COMPLAINTS, RECORDS, RENTALS, ETC.), I'M NOT SURE (HELP ME DECIDE WHO TO TALK TO) (12:43:08 PM) Web User 66abe4c05e5633b5b1d18aa1: Other services (complaints, records, rentals, etc.) (12:43:09 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: Please give us a little more information so we can prepare for our chat. (12:43:11 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services: (12:46:02 PM) Web User 66abe4c05e5633b5b1d18aa1: What type of services do you need help with?: Inspections Please tell us how we can help you:: If you have received a call from Anissa Yesterday regarding an inspection that I ordered a month ago. regarding a leak in our apartment building . The leak has since been fixed, but the mold and mildew remain. I have had negative. experiences with Anissa Record number (or type "n/a"): na Site address or parcel number (or type "n/a"): 1110 8th ave (12:46:03 PM) SDCI Virtual Applicant Services:

Thanks! We are finding the right person to help you. The average wait is 5 minutes (but could be up to 30 minutes). We appreciate your patience. (12:46:11 PM) SDCI Support Team (auto reply): While you wait, please add any extra information or attachments that might help our team answer your question more quickly. (12:46:12 PM) SDCI Support Team (auto reply): No time to wait? Don't worry, we have your ticket and will reply by email within 2 business days. (12:46:16 PM) SDCI Support Team (auto reply): Please note that this customer service feature is intended for preliminary coaching and should not be construed as permit review, approval, or definitive analysis of any code provisions as they may apply to a specific project. (12:47:30 PM) Kimberly Coleman: I am writing to address a recent issue with an inspection scheduled by Anissa from SDCI. This appointment, regarding a leak that has already been resolved, was requested over a month ago. Unfortunately, I have had previous negative interactions with Anissa, including an incident where she exited her car during a conversation to intimidate me. Due to this unprofessional behavior, I respectfully request a different inspector. Furthermore, Anissa was previously responsible for issuing a notice of violation over a year ago, which she failed to follow up on. Given these circumstances, I believe it is reasonable to insist on a new inspector for this inspection. Additionally, I would like to inquire about the status of the 100% inspection of the Lowell Emerson Apartments, which was supposed to be conducted on August 1st. Thank you for your understanding and cooperation. I look forward to your prompt response. (12:48:29 PM) Kimberly Coleman: please assign a different inspector and have them reach out asap 22063356332 (12:52:20 PM) Kimberly Coleman: hello (12:56:11 PM) Chu, Irving: Hi, i'm sorry you're having this issue with your inspector. Our inspectors do not use this chat function and so I'll have to forward this information to them as well as your preference for a 11/9/24, 3:08 AM Gmail - Request #399725: How would you rate the support you received? <https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permmsgid=msg-f:1806862242158435780&simpl=msg-f:1806862242158435780> 3/4 different inspector. (12:57:45 PM) Chu, Irving: Alright, so your ticket has been submitted to them and a staff member from their group will get back to you by email within 2 business days. You wont need to continue with this chat box anymore, but if you want you cab reply with all additional details to your questions to help them answer your questions sooner. Kind regards, This email is a service from Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections. Delivered by Zendesk [0D7MG9-6G66R] 11/9/24, 3:08 AM Gmail - Request #399725: How would you rate the support you received? <https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permmsgid=msg-f:1806862242158435780&simpl=msg-f:1806862242158435780> 4/4From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Fwd: [City of Seattle] Re: When can I expect the information for the. inspections that

are going to take place at the lowell emerson apts. 2 messages

info@metrentsmanagement.com Sun, Aug 4, 2024 at 6:35 PM To: kmcdm75@gmail.com

----- Original Message ----- Subject:[City of Seattle] Re: When can I expect the information for the. inspections that are going to take place at the lowell emerson apts. Date:2024-07-11 23:17 From:"Shelby Allison (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections)" To:Info Reply-To:Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections ##- Please type your reply above this line -## Your request (396225) has been updated. To add additional comments, reply to this email. To submit a new request, click here. Shelby Allison (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections) Jul 11, 2024, 4:17 PM PDT Hello Sam, Thank you for reaching out. Can you please be a little more specific about what information you're looking for? There are several open inspection records for this property including inspection 004-0058451 that took place with Inspector Anissa Streb on 12/7/23 and 12/14/23 that will require a reinspection. Any questions about this should be directed towards Anissa at 206-920-4137 or anissa.streb@seattle.gov There is also an expanded inspection 004-0074780 which is looking at all remaining units at this property. This one has been scheduled for 10/2/24 and 10/9/24. Please let me know if you have any additional questions or can provide any other details for me to direct your question accordingly. Best, Shelby RRIO Team 11/9/24, 3:11 AM Gmail - Fwd: [City of Seattle] Re: When can I expect the information for the. inspections that are going to take place at the lowell em...

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1806509548053528765&simpl=msg-f:1806509548053528765> 1/2 Info Jul 11, 2024, 8:28AM PDT

When can I expect the information for the inspections that are going to take place at the Little Emerson Apartments? I believe they are supposed to be here on the first of August. This email is a service from Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections. Delivered by Zendesk [PGGMWR-37XYK] From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Wed, Oct 30, 2024 at 4:11 PM Draft On Sun, Aug 4, 2024 at 6:35 PM wrote: ----- Original Message ----- Subject:[City of Seattle] Re: When can I expect the information for the. inspections that are going to take place at the lowell emerson apts. Date:2024-07-11 23:17 From:"Shelby Allison (Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections)" ort@sdci.zendes To:Info Reply-To:Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections [Quoted text hidden] 11/9/24, 3:11 AM Gmail - Fwd: [City of Seattle] Re: When can I expect the information for the. inspections that are going to take place at the lowell em...

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1806509548053528765&simpl=msg-f:1806509548053528765> 2/2 From The Desk Of

Kimberly Coleman Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement –Re:
Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections 2 messages From The Desk
Of Kimberly Coleman Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 3:50 PM To:

"Schwartzenger, Lisa" Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Hello Lisa, Thank you for
your response, but I believe there's been a misunderstanding. My concerns
are not about the management of my property, nor am I seeking legal
advice about my landlord. I'm inquiring about SDCI's enforcement
practices and the accountability measures for RRIO
compliance—responsibilities directly under SDCI's oversight. While the
RRIO Ordinance provides a framework, my questions focus on how SDCI
ensures that this ordinance is followed consistently and effectively.

Specifically: 1. Enforcement Practices: What measures are taken when
SDCI finds evidence of false certifications? How does SDCI handle
non-compliance when inspections reveal ongoing issues, as seen at Lowell
Emerson? 2. Accountability for Oversight: Given that tenants depend on
SDCI to enforce minimum standards, what systems are in place to ensure
that false certifications, lack of registration, and chronic issues are actively
addressed across all affected properties? I look forward to receiving a
response that clarifies SDCI's role in actively enforcing RRIO compliance,
rather than redirecting the responsibility to external entities. Thank you
for your attention to this matter. Best regards, Kimberly Coleman On Thu,
Oct 31, 2024, 2:34 PM Schwartzenger, Lisa wrote: Please see responses
below to your questions. I understand you have many concerns, but all
information regarding the execution of the RRIO program can be found in
the RRIO Ordinance. That is the code in which we follow and all processes
are outlined very clearly. Some of your questions appear to be about
property management, and we do not oversee property management in the

City of Seattle. Our job is to enforce the RRIO ordinance and the Housing Building Maintenance Code. If you are having issues with your property management I would encourage to reach out to an attorney or contact 211 for more resources to assist you. Lisa 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 1/9 LISA SCHWARTZENBERGER | SENIOR RRIO/HOUSING

ZONING INSPECTOR Seattle Department of Construction & Inspections | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seattle, WA 98124-4019 P: 206-684-0984 | F: 206-615-1812 E: Lisa.Schwartzberger@seattle.gov

Facebook | X | Blog From: From The Desk Of Kimberly

Coleman Sent: Thursday, October 31, 2024 2:18 PM To: Schwartzberger, Lisa Cc: Streb, Anissa Subject: Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections Lisa, Thank you for your response. I understand the expanded RRIO inspection process as outlined in Ordinance 22.214. However, my concern goes beyond the specific RRIO procedures or the compliance of my landlord. The issue here is SDCI's accountability in enforcing the ordinance and ensuring that properties are genuinely compliant with Seattle's rental standards—something that the department has consistently overlooked. While I understand that RRIO inspections may be selective, the systemic gaps in enforcement raise significant questions. For instance, there was no flag raised when SDCI's inspectors encountered a rental property lacking proper registration in the RRIO system. This is not about one record number or inspection result; it's about whether SDCI actively enforces the ordinance and fulfills its responsibility to tenants across the

city. I would appreciate it if we could address the following points directly:
3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement
–Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 2/9

1. Accountability for Non-Compliance: How does SDCI ensure that RRIO violations by property managers are adequately investigated, particularly when there are ongoing issues with false certifications? Code Compliance (the inspection team) conducts inspections on properties/structures. We do not investigate any property management issues between landlords and tenants. Certifications are made at the time of registration, and property maintenance/building conditions can change at anytime after registration, which is why properties are randomly selected at least once every 5-10 years for inspection.

2. Clear Enforcement Standards: Beyond selecting properties at random, what measures are in place to guarantee that RRIO requirements are upheld for all properties—especially when non-compliance is observed? The RRIO ordinance selects registered properties for inspection. If properties have a failed RRIO inspection they are allowed time to make repairs or may incur enforcement action if repairs are not made. You can read the RRIO Ordinance to review what the enforcement process entails. Thank you for acknowledging these broader concerns. It's crucial that SDCI prioritizes tenant safety through a proactive enforcement approach, as outlined in the ordinance.

Best regards, Kimberly Coleman

Image removed by sender. On Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 1:54 PM Schwarzenberger, Lisa wrote: Hello, To clarify, the inspections conducted on October 2 nd and 9 th were part of an expanded RRIO inspection. Expanded inspections

mean the property's initial RRIO inspections failed and additional units were selected for inspection, per the Ordinance. I would encourage you to review the Rental Registration Inspection Ordinance (22.214). The Ordinance specifically outlines the process in which rental properties will be chosen for inspection. Please refer to 22.214.050 (G) (3) for explanation of the expanded RRIO process, to explain why not all of the units were not inspected on the October dates. 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 3/9

As for Metropolitan Management's properties, all properties registered with the RRIO program will follow the selection process as specified in the Ordinance. We will conduct inspections once a property is randomly selected. Once chosen, the property will be inspected to protect the health, safety and welfare of the tenants residing at the property. SDCI will determine if any RRIO registration certifications were falsely made. As for your question to Anissa regarding a pre-registration number, please be aware that a preregistration number that is attached to a housing complaint is for internal purposes only. The properties at Lowell-Emerson are registered with the RRIO program, information which is available on the Seattle Services Portal. If a housing complaint is received by SDCI, we will schedule and complete a housing inspection following the Housing Building Maintenance Code (HMBC) and not the RRIO checklist. Please note that these are two different types of inspections our inspectors conduct. A property owner is able to hire a private inspector to conduct their RRIO inspection whereas only City of Seattle inspectors can conduct

an HBMC housing inspection. I understand your frustration with your property management company, however please know we are working diligently with them to improve housing conditions at Lowell-Emerson and that they are working very hard to come into compliance. Lisa LISA SCHWARTZENBERGER | SENIOR RRIO/HOUSING ZONING INSPECTOR Seattle Department of Construction & Inspections | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seattle, WA 98124-4019 P: 206-684-0984 | F: 206-615-1812 E: Lisa.Schwartzzenberger@seattle.gov

Facebook | X | Blog From: From The Desk Of Kimberly

Coleman Sent: Thursday, October 31, 2024 1:16 PM To: Schwartzzenberger, Lisa Cc: Streb, Anissa Subject: Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspecons Hi Lisa, It's nice to hear from you again. Thank you for your prompt response. Yes, I am aware that the inspection did not end 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 4/9 up including my unit E402, which raises my question, could you please explain why the planned 100% property inspections on October 2nd and 9th were not completed. What was the deviation that hindered the planned 100% property inspection? I'm also very concerned, given the evidence of discrepancies, about Metropolitan Management's ongoing falsification of selfcertification, which seems to have been happening for over a decade. Given SDCI's authority to penalize and revoke registrations for such RRIO violations, what actions will be taken across all Metropolitan Management properties? Specifically: Is SDCI using its full authority to ensure all Metropolitan Management properties meet

minimum housing code standards? Will all Metropolitan Management properties receive a comprehensive 100% inspection, given the continued pattern of self-certifying despite ongoing issues? How is SDCI addressing this situation to enforce RRIO standards, ensure tenant safety, and hold Metropolitan Management accountable for false certifications? Thank you for addressing these urgent concerns. oh, one more question, Anissa worked on this complaint so maybe she can help bring clarity to the issue.

Reference: Record Number: 001065-23CP (HOUSING - PRE.REG.

#001-0146962) Duplicate Reference: Record Number: 000897-23CP

Record #000897-23CP is marked as a duplicate and references record, 001065-23, which, in turn, references preregistration #001-0146962.

3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement

–Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 5/9 My question concerns the pre-registration number

associated with this record, as I am unable to find any correlation between this number and the property in question within the RRIO system. My understanding is that RRIO pre-registration numbers are issued specifically to properties upon their registration in the RRIO system.

However, searching for this particular property yields no indication of its RRIO registration, and it appears that the associated duplicate record is not for this property at all but rather references a completely separate location. Could you please clarify: 1. Why was this property assigned an RRIO pre-registration number (#001-0146962) in the notes when it does not appear registered with RRIO? 2. How complaints from tenants associated with this property were handled without a formal RRIO

registration? I'm trying to understand why there was no flag raised in response to a complaint for a property that lacks a current RRIO registration and why this pre-registration number is referenced in the absence of official RRIO records. Thank you both for your time. Kimberly Coleman Image removed by sender. On Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:40 AM Schwartzenberger, Lisa wrote: Hello Ms. Coleman, I am the Senior RRIO Inspector and Anissa forwarded me your email. The expanded RRIO inspections that were completed by myself and another inspector on October 2 nd & 9 th , did not include your unit, E402. Inspection results are sent to property management/ownership for repairs to be completed.

3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO Enforcement
–Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...> 6/9 If you would like a copy of the inspection results that do not include your unit, you may submit a public disclosure request to the City of Seattle. If you have any questions, or I can be of further assistance, please let me know. Lisa LISA SCHWARTZENBERGER | SENIOR RRIO/HOUSING ZONING INSPECTOR Seattle Department of Construction & Inspections | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seattle, WA 98124-4019 P: 206-684-0984 | F: 206-615-1812 E: Lisa.Schwartzenberger@seattle.gov Facebook | X | Blog

From: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Wednesday, October 30, 2024 4:15 PM To: Streb, Anissa Subject: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspecons CAUTION: External Email Anissa, I am looking for the Inspection results of the inspections that took place on Oct 2nd and 9th. I cannot locate any record of 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for

Accountability in RRIO Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments
RRIO inspections

[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878
363567...](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...) 7/9 them in the portal. Would you please forward the reports to

me at your earliest convenience? Thank you, Kimberly Coleman 7

attachments ~WRD0002.jpg 1K image001.png 7K image001.png 7K

~WRD0002.jpg 1K image001.png 7K ~WRD0002.jpg 1K image001.png 7K

Schwartzenberger, Lisa Mon, Nov 4, 2024 at 1:46 PM To: From The Desk
Of Kimberly Coleman 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability
in RRIO Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878
363567...](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...) 8/9 Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Hello, I have stated several times now the

answers as to how we enforce under the Rental Registration Inspection
Ordinance are written within the Ordinance. Once deficiencies are found at
the time of inspection notices are issued and may ultimately results in
monetary penalties and possible legal action depending on the type of
notice issued under RRIO or HBMC. As for accountability, again as I have
stated previously, the Ordinance outlines the registration requirements,
addressing certification discrepancies and enforcement procedures that we
follow. I have repeatedly responded to the same questions now and have
no other answers for you other than referring you to the Ordinance that
outline the processes and procedures we follow. You seem to be searching
for something that I cannot provide. We enforce the code as written and do
not deviate from it. If you need assistance in understanding the Code, I
encourage you to reach out and obtain legal assistance. [Quoted text

hidden] 3/6/25, 7:34 PM Gmail - Request for Accountability in RRIO
Enforcement –Re: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections
[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878
363567...](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r4427595682456327302&simpl=msg-a:r627047878363567...) 9/9

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Construction & Inspections ::
C201761-101924 10 messages City of Seattle Public Records Request
Center Tue, Dec 3, 2024 at 3:27 PM To: "Kmcdm75@gmail.com" --- Please
respond above this line --- Dear K Coleman, Records are now available in
response to your request C201761-101924 regarding the following:
PLEASE PROVIDE THE DIRECTORS REPORTS DESCRIBED BELOW
FOR 2017-PRESENT thank you section 9. The Director shall report
annually to the Affordable Housing, Neighborhoods and Finance
Committee, or its successor committee, on all activity related to Section
22.206.180.J. This report shall include the number of inquiries from
tenants and landlords, the number of inspections related to this provision,
the outcome of those inspections, the number of housing cost increases
delayed based on a determination by the department or refunds or credits
required, and any interactions and information related to the Department's
involvement in any eviction proceedings. To the extent feasible, the
Director should obtain records on evictions in Seattle and review those
records to determine if the Department conducted inspections at those
locations related to Section 22.206.180.J and if the eviction resulted from
application of this Section 22.206.180.J. The report shall be delivered to
the Council by no later than June 15 of the following calendar year

(beginning June 15, 2017). please also provide the amount of the SDCI budget that is allocated toward the tenant landlord-inspections/enforcement regulations. thank you

The records being made available to you at this time include the following: One document provided by Geoff Tallent which may be responsive to your request. Other than this document, no other responsive records were found. To download your records, please: Navigate to the Public Records Request Center. Select 'My Records Request Center'. Select 'View My Requests'. You may be asked to login. Select this request: C201761-101924. Select the 'View Files' button. You can download records individually or all at the same time by clicking 'Download All'. Please save your records as you may only download them from the system three times. If you do not download your records within 30 days of request closure, the link to your records will expire. If you believe you have received privileged or confidential records in error, please notify the City of Seattle immediately, through the Public Records Request Center or by email. Privileged or confidential records provided or received in error should not be reviewed, used, disseminated, distributed, or copied, and should be destroyed immediately. Thank you in advance for your cooperation. The Department of Construction and Inspections has now provided all responsive records. We consider your request closed and plan to take no further action to fulfill this request. If you have any follow-up questions or would like to initiate an administrative appeal under MDAR 17-0002 Section 6, please contact us within 10 business days after downloading your records, after which this request will no longer be monitored for communications. You may also seek judicial review of our response to your request for a period of one year, beginning as of the date of this message, consistent with RCW 42.56.550. 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail -

Construction & Inspections :: C201761-101924

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1817463670804770372&simpl=msg-f:181746367080477037...> 1/3 Sincerely, Josy Rush Public Disclosure Officer Construction

& Inspections To monitor the progress, update this request, make payments and download your responsive records please log into the Public Records Request Center. From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Tue, Dec 3, 2024 at 4:11 PM To: City of Seattle Public Records Request Center Thank you very much for this document. I requested 2017 to present I. am inquiring about where the other. 7 reports are. Thank you. [Quoted text hidden] From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Tue, Dec 3, 2024 at 4:36 PM To: City of Seattle Public Records Request Center Also, my colleague requested the records on the attached file. and has not received anything they were supposed to be received by November 3rd. Can you please give us an update on that? On Tue, Dec 3, 2024 at 3:27 PM City of Seattle Public Records Request Center wrote: [Quoted text hidden]

Construction-Inspections-C199540-100124-metrentsmanagement-gmail-com-Gmail-12-03- 2024_04_32_PM.png 779K Mailtrack Reminder Wed, Dec 4, 2024 at 4:36 PM Reply-To: seattle@mycusthelp.net To:

kmcdm75@gmail.com ⚠ Your email to seattle@mycusthelp.net has not been opened yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H (disable) From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Thu, Dec 5, 2024 at 10:35 AM To: City of Seattle Public Records Request Center i'm waiting for a response... On Tue, Dec 3, 2024 at 3:27 PM City of Seattle Public Records Request Center wrote: [Quoted text hidden] Mailtrack Reminder Fri, Dec 6, 2024 at 10:35 AM 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - Construction & Inspections :: C201761-101924

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all>

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1817463670804770372&simpl=msg-f:181746367080477037...> 2/3 Reply-To: seattle@mycusthelp.net To:

kmcdm75@gmail.com [Quoted text hidden] Mailtrack Reminder Fri, Dec 6, 2024 at 4:11 PM Reply-To: seattle@mycusthelp.net To:

kmcdm75@gmail.com 📧 You've not received a reply yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H Mailtrack Reminder Fri, Dec 6, 2024 at 4:36 PM Reply-To:

seattle@mycusthelp.net To: kmcdm75@gmail.com [Quoted text hidden] Mailtrack Reminder Sun, Dec 8, 2024 at 10:35 AM Reply-To:

seattle@mycusthelp.net To: kmcdm75@gmail.com [Quoted text hidden]

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sun, Dec 8, 2024 at 11:13 PM To:

City of Seattle Public Records Request Center The SDCI is mandated to provide the report to the office of housing every year and I would

appreciate it if I could have the years 2017 to 2022. Also I was addressing a request that my colleague still has not heard from sdcI about which we

were supposed to have early November please see below. Also, my

colleague requested the records on the attached file. and has not received

anything they were supposed to be received by November 3rd. Can you

please give us an update on that? [Quoted text hidden] 3/6/25, 7:39 PM

Gmail - Construction & Inspections :: C201761-101924

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1817463670804770372&simpl=msg-f:181746367080477037...>

3/3

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP 16
messages Hinch, Stephen Mon, Jun 17, 2024 at 5:40 PM To:
"kmcdm75@gmail.com" Cc: "Lum, Gregory" Good evening Your phone
contact informaon is non working. If you would like an inspecon of your
unit and building please reach out to Inspector Lum CCd to schedule your
inspecon. Thank you Stephen Hinch Code Compliance Buildings Manager
Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections O: 206-386-1987 | |
stephen.hinch@seattle.gov Helping people build a safe, livable, and
inclusive Seattle. SDCI offers most services online through our Virtual
Applicant Services Center. For customers who need language assistance or
technical assistance accessing the Virtual ASC, we have an SDCI
information desk on the 4th floor of the Seattle Municipal Tower. We offer
limited access to our offices for scheduled public meetings. From The Desk
Of Kimberly Coleman Tue, Jun 25, 2024 at 10:52 AM To: "Hinch, Stephen"
Hey Steven. Kimberly Coleman here. It's my understanding that Gregory
Lum is out for the week. He was supposed to forward my information to
his supervisor. Would that be Eric Jenkins? please have someone reach out
to me today in order to make an appointment to come and inspect these
buildings. You need. 3 or 4 inspectors.. Thank you. I look forward to
hearing back from you soon. Sender notified by Mailtrack sender notified
by Mail Track for Gmail [Quoted text hidden] Mailtrack Notification Tue,
Jun 25, 2024 at 1:16 PM Reply-To: stephen.hinch@seattle.gov To:
kmcdm75@gmail.com 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave
006346-24CP
[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025
8238](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238)... 1/13 🔥 Hot conversation: Hinch, Stephen opened it many times in

a short period or forwarded it. View all 5 opens | turn off hot conversations

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Thu, Jun 27, 2024 at 8:08 AM To: "Hinch, Stephen" Good morning Stephen. I need your assistance real quick. So I heard from Chris. Thank you but I really don't think. I would like to work with him. There is a clear. Defensiveness, that I get off him. That is very uncomfortable, so could you do me a favor he's here at 10 AM and I'm wondering if you can check first to see if you have someone else that can be here today, can you get me someone else here today? Whatever time I just don't want to work with Chris, but if you can't find anybody else then just let him come. I guess but it just doesn't seem like. He understand. S what we've been through here or is empathetic at all to our situation thank you I appreciate it. I can't reach you because you guys don't answer your phone today until ten thirty so would you do me a favor and call me at 2063356 thirty 32 so that I know first of all that you receive this and that if you can do anything for me thanks so much [Quoted text hidden] Hinch,

Stephen Thu, Jun 27, 2024 at 8:26 AM To: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Cc: "Jenkins, Eric" , "Hou, Kevin" Good morning Kimberly Please accept our apologies for your uncomfortable experience. I am including Inspector Johanning's and housing inspecon supervisors to aend to your request. Thank you Stephen Hinch Code Compliance Buildings Manager Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections O: 206-386-1987 | | stephen.hinch@seattle.gov Helping people build a safe, livable, and inclusive Seattle. SDCI offers most services online through our Virtual Applicant Services Center. For customers who need language assistance or technical assistance accessing the Virtual ASC, we have an SDCI information desk on the 4th floor of the Seattle Municipal Tower. We offer limited access to our offices for scheduled public meetings. From: From

The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Thursday, June 27, 2024 8:08 AM
To: Hinch, Stephen Subject: Re: 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP CAUTION:
External Email [Quoted text hidden] Hou, Kevin Thu, Jun 27, 2024 at 8:51
AM To: "Hinch, Stephen" , From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Cc:
"Jenkins, Eric" , "Streb, Anissa" Hi Kimberly, 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail -
1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025
8238](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238)... 2/13 I'd reassigned your current complaint from Chris to Anissa

who will take over your 10am inspection scheduled with Chris. My
understanding is that you wish to not work with Anissa either. The reason
why I assigned the complaints to Anissa is because she currently has an
active case that she's working to resolve and I do not want multiple
inspectors creating cases separately. Anissa is set to meet with you at 10am
if you are available to meet, however, she reported that you'd hung up on
her when she called to confirm today's meeting. Please let Anissa know
your availability so that she can make arrangements to meet with you.

Regards, Kevin Kevin Hou Housing and Zoning Inspector Manager Seattle
Department of Construction and Inspections Office: 206.615.1613 I Fax:
206.615.1812 I kevin.hou@seattle.gov Facebook I Twitter I Blog Helping
people build a safe, livable, and inclusive Seattle. SDCI offers most services
online through our Virtual Applicant Services Center. We offer limited
access to our office for scheduled meetings. Thank you for your flexibility
and patience as we continue to improve our online and in-person customer
service options. [Quoted text hidden] image001.png 10K Mailtrack

Reminder Fri, Jun 28, 2024 at 10:52 AM Reply-To:

stephen.hinch@seattle.gov To: kmcdm75@gmail.com  You've not

received a reply yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Fri, Jun 28, 2024 at 5:29 PM To: "Hou, Kevin" , "Hinch, Stephen" Cc: "Jenkins, Eric" , "Streb, Anissa" , geoff.tallent@seattle.gov, "Johanning, Chris" , Scott.Thiessen@seattle.gov 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP <https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238>... 3/13 Dear Mr. Hou, Context and Current Situation Let me provide some context so you understand that I am not an unreasonable person. Through thorough investigation and 4 1/2 years experience living at The Lowell Emerson, it is clear that there is a massive breakdown in your operating procedures and the regulation and enforcement of ordinances meant to protect affordable housing and tenants in Seattle. In 2023, I founded the Lowell Emerson Tenant Association out of sheer necessity due to the stressful living conditions, the state of our units, and the incomprehensible treatment we were experiencing. I advised tenants to utilize the SDCI portal because I believed in the regulations you enforce. However, it has become evident that our reporting has not been effective in bringing about the desperately needed maintenance and improvements at Lowell Emerson Apartments. When complaints in the portal increased, they were the same issues that had been documented for over a decade. These repeated complaints led to Notices of Violation (NOVs) being issued but not resolved. In May 2023, due to tenant pressure, an investigation revealed over 80 violations in common areas and four units. These NOVs included unresolved complaints that had come in months before, but SDCI did not come to investigate these complaints until we demanded intervention. Metropolitan Management was given two months to address

these violations but selfcertified compliance in November, despite ongoing issues. This was against the policy that extensions are only granted if substantial improvements are made. Complaints continued to pour in throughout 2023, showing the same unresolved issues. This leads me to the current issue- a plumbing complaint in February 2024 escalated to severe flooding by June, affecting multiple floors and causing extensive damage. Despite this, no proper measures were taken to address mold or mildew resulting from the flooding. Chris Johannian, assigned to the initial plumbing complaint, did not investigate or inspect the property. Anissa is responsible for unresolved NOVs, yet the property is certified with RRIO. 006346- 24CP 005920- 24CP 005711- 24CP 001616- 24CP 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238>... 4/13 This indicates a systemic failure in SDCI's enforcement and regulation processes, allowing landlords to self-certify compliance without proper verification. The audit by the city auditor's office on RRIO, which was meant to clarify the loss of rental units in Seattle, is also flawed. The numbers provided by Jeff Tallent are inflated and do not reflect the actual availability of affordable housing units that he presented to the City Council earlier this month. The broader implication of these oversight failures is profound, contributing significantly to the housing crisis in Seattle by diminishing the quality and affordability of available housing. This systemic issue seems exacerbated by the RRIO's intent to streamline and enhance the efficiency of complaint resolution and oversight, yet in practice, it appears to facilitate leniency towards habitual offenders like Metropolitan Management, who exploit the system's gaps at the expense of

vulnerable tenants. In light of these facts, I must question the wisdom of assigning single inspectors to complex cases that span multiple categories of compliance, such as structural integrity, plumbing, electrical, and fire safety. Inspector Anissa Streb, despite her efforts, has not demonstrated the capacity to enforce necessary improvements within the provided timelines. I recommend reassessing her assignments and considering the appointment of a specialized team of inspectors, each with expertise in different areas, to handle such multifaceted issues more effectively. Additionally, I urge the SDCI, along with the RRIO department, to conduct a thorough review of the Housing and Maintenance code along with the RRIO and the provisions of the Downtown Maintenance and Housing code, to reassess the framework for violations, the rights and limits of self-certification, and the enforcement of penalties as originally intended. Your attention to these matters and a reevaluation of current inspection protocols could significantly improve living conditions and ensure compliance with legal standards, ultimately serving the best interests of Seattle's residents. I would appreciate it if you could facilitate Inspector Scott Theissen to inspect my unit. I find him neutral, reliable, and effective. I can be reached at 206-335-6332. Thank you for your time and attention to these critical issues. I look forward to your prompt response and to seeing meaningful action taken. Best regards, Kimberly Coleman

Summary of Issues with SDCI Complaint Handling

1. Inconsistent Use of the Portal:

3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238>... 5/13 Many complaints in the portal are closed as "Admin closed-no contact" without any indication that an inspection was conducted. The

portal has multiple sections (notes, inspections and appointments, project description) where updates can be recorded, but these are often underutilized.

2. Lack of Inspection Follow-Through: Inspectors have indicated that they attempt to reach out to complainants and close the complaint if they receive no response, contrary to the stated process that requires an inspection. Reports from tenants and personal experiences suggest that the complaint process often ends with an email acknowledgment and no further action. There are instances where appointments are scheduled but not kept, leading to further frustration.

3. Prolonged and Incomplete Investigations: Complaints remain under investigation for extended periods (6 months to 2 years) without resolution. Complaints are closed with statuses like "intake," "no contact," "admin closed," or "no violation observed" on the same day, indicating a lack of thorough investigation.

4. Critical Issues Not Addressed Timely: Complaints involving critical issues (e.g., no hot water, no heat, leaks, floods, electrical issues, elevator breakdowns) are often closed without resolution, marked as "no violation observed" or "admin closed." The untimely manner in which these were addressed have resulted in tenants having already vacated the premises due to uninhabitable living conditions. And these complaints are closed, remaining unresolved. What do you think the outcome for the next tenant is going to be in a situation like this?

5. Retaliation and Repeat Offenders: There is a high incidence of retaliation by landlords, especially in buildings managed by slumlords. SDCI should recognize patterns of recurring complaints in specific buildings and take proactive measures. Records should be monitored to ensure that repeated issues are not closed without proper resolution.

6. Lack of Enforcement and Prolonged Compliance: Metropolitan

Management, in particular, tends to address maintenance issues only after being cited by SDCI. 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP <https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238>... 6/13 Even when violations are identified, enforcement is lax, and compliance is delayed beyond acceptable timeframes. Suggestions for Improvement

1. Enhanced Portal Utilization: Implement stricter guidelines for updating the complaint portal with detailed notes on inspections, actions taken, and follow-ups.
2. Guaranteed Inspections: Ensure that all complaints, especially those involving critical issues, are followed by an on-site inspection regardless of initial contact attempts.
3. Timely and Transparent Updates: Provide regular updates to complainants on the status of their complaint, including reasons for any delays or closures.
4. Monitoring and Accountability: Establish a system to track recurring complaints in specific buildings and take preemptive actions. Hold landlords accountable with stricter penalties for repeat offenses and prolonged non-compliance.
5. Clear Communication and Support: Improve communication channels between SDCI and tenants to ensure they are informed about the process and their rights. Provide support to tenants facing retaliation, ensuring their complaints are taken seriously and acted upon promptly.
6. Enforcement and Penalties: Enforce penalties as per the regulations without undue extensions, unless substantial improvement is demonstrated. Monitor compliance closely and take immediate action for non-compliance.

Conclusion The lack of enforcement and accountability within SDCI is contributing to the deterioration of affordable housing in Seattle. Currently, there is no requirement for private inspectors or owner agents to provide detailed inspection reports, leading

to a lack of accountability. 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave
006346-24CP

[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025
8238...](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238) 7/13 This situation is unacceptable and requires immediate

attention to ensure safe and habitable living conditions for all tenants.

sender notified by Mail Track for Gmail Sender notified by Mailtrack

Mailtrack Reminder Mon, Jul 1, 2024 at 5:29 PM Reply-To:

kevin.hou@seattle.gov, stephen.hinch@seattle.gov,

eric.jenkins@seattle.gov, anissa.streb@seattle.gov,

geoff.tallent@seattle.gov, chris.johanning@seattle.gov,

scott.thiessen@seattle.gov To: kmcdm75@gmail.com [Quoted text hidden]

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Tue, Jul 2, 2024 at 2:26 PM To:

kevin.hou@seattle.gov, stephen.hinch@seattle.gov,

eric.jenkins@seattle.gov, geoff.tallent@seattle.gov,

scott.thiessen@seattle.gov Good Afternoon, I have not received any

response or acknowledgment from SDCI, and this delay is only solidifying

the points I've made in regards to the response time and from the SDCI. It

is crucial that an inspection be conducted promptly to address these

violations and ensure compliance with housing codes. Could someone

please provide an update on the status of my request and confirm when I

can expect an inspector to visit the property? The urgency of this matter

cannot be overstated, and I appreciate your immediate attention to this

issue. Thank you for your prompt response. Best regards, Kimberly

Coleman 206-335-6332 sender notified by Mail Track for Gmail Sender

notified by Mailtrack 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all>

[&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025](#)

[8238](#)... 8/13 Tallent, Geoff Wed, Jul 3, 2024 at 11:57 AM To: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman , "Hou, Kevin" , "Hinch, Stephen" Cc: "Jenkins, Eric" , "Streb, Anissa" , "Johanning, Chris" , "Thiessen, Scott" Hello Ms. Coleman, I'm responding to your RRIO-related concerns. I'll let our inspection team respond to your concerns with the complaint-based inspections, since I have not been involved with those. First, you stated "The numbers provided by Jeff Tallent are inflated and do not reflect the actual availability of affordable housing units that he presented to the City Council earlier this month." I'm puzzled by this statement. I did not present on the number of affordable housing units. I presented on the number of all housing units registered with the RRIO program. The numbers I presented were taken from our registration database and were accurate. Second, you are concerned about the property owner's ability to self-certify when they renewed their rental registration with the City. Self-certification is allowed in the City code. It was intentional by the City Council when they passed the RRIO ordinance. It would take a change in law by the City Council to require more than self-certification. Third, the property owner's certification notwithstanding, the RRIO program has identified many maintenance issues in the property through our proactive random inspections. Based on the results from two rounds of increasing unit inspections, we have now required that 100% of the units complete and pass RRIO inspections. Our RRIO enforcement lead has been in contact with the property owners and we understand they are working toward meeting this requirement. We will be monitoring for progress.

-Geoff From: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Friday, June 28, 2024 5:30 PM To: Hou, Kevin ; Hinch, Stephen Cc: Jenkins, Eric ; Streb,

Anissa ; Tallent, Geoff ; Johanning, Chris ; Thiessen, Sco Subject: Re: 1110
8th Ave 006346-24CP 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave
006346-24CP

[https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all
&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025
8238...](https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:18021574310258238) 9/13 CAUTION: External Email Dear Mr. Hou, [Quoted text

hidden] [Quoted text hidden] sender notified by Mail Track for Gmail Click
to remove Sender notified by Mailtrack 06/28/24, 05:29:06 PM Mailtrack
Reminder Wed, Jul 3, 2024 at 2:26 PM Reply-To: kevin.hou@seattle.gov,
stephen.hinch@seattle.gov, eric.jenkins@seattle.gov,
geoff.tallent@seattle.gov, scott.thiessen@seattle.gov To:

kmcdm75@gmail.com  Your email to kevin.hou@seattle.gov has not
been opened yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H (disable) From The Desk Of
Kimberly Coleman Fri, Jul 5, 2024 at 10:24 AM To: "Tallent, Geoff" , Kevin
, Stephen , Eric , Anissa , Chris , Scott Dear Mr. Tallent, Thank you for your
response to my concerns regarding the RRIO program, self-certification,
and the enforcement of the ordinance. However, based on a thorough
analysis of the records and the ordinances, it is clear that the issues I raised
are not adequately addressed by your explanations. You mentioned that
you did not present the numbers of affordable housing units but rather the
total number of housing units registered with the RRIO program. I
apologize for any confusion in my previous statement. However, the core
issue remains that the registration data for Metropolitan Management's
properties, including the Lowell Emerson Apartments, is inflated and does
not accurately reflect the compliance status of these units.

Self-Certification Concerns 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave
006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025823...>

10/13 The RRIO ordinance clearly outlines the conditions under which self-certification can be challenged and revoked, especially when there is evidence of false declarations or consistent non-compliance. Ordinance 22.214.050 mandates that properties with multiple violations or emergency orders prior to the ordinance must undergo more stringent inspection processes. The records show numerous violations and complaints dating back to before 2014. For example, complaints about no heat, no hot water, elevator breakdowns, and substandard conditions were consistently reported but not properly addressed, as indicated by the status section stating that complaints like these were admin closed. Specifically, complaint 002173-14CP was unfortunately not followed up on time, and the conditions the tenant had to endure were unacceptable. SDCI made no attempt to promptly call her, and by the time they got around to it, she had already moved out. The unit was not inspected to ensure this unit was in compliance. Violation History Emerson received 3 NOVs and an emergency order combined with the Lowell, reported to the SDCI 13 times before the RRIO ordinance was enacted in 2014. Despite these ongoing issues, self-certifications were accepted without inspections. Examples of Pre-2014 Violations: 1032227-VI: Repeated issues with heat and substandard living conditions. 1018821-VI: Persistent complaints about lack of maintenance and safety hazards. 1018493-VI: Multiple complaints about elevator breakdowns and unsafe conditions. 1016158-VI: Lack of heat and hot water consistently reported without proper resolution. The ordinance requires that properties with two or more violations or emergency orders within two years before the ordinance should have been

subject to mandatory inspections. The consistent pattern of violations and lack of compliance at Lowell Emerson should have triggered these mandatory inspections long ago. Evidence of False Certification: The records indicate that Metropolitan Management repeatedly failed to comply with inspection requirements and falsely certified compliance. This is evident from the repeated issuance and withdrawal of NOVs without proper follow-up inspections each year. One notice of violation spanned from March 2017 to the end of 2020. It took three years for this notice of violation to be cured by Metropolitan Management, and in those three years, they self-certified the Lowell Emerson Apartments as 100% inspected and passed. During this period, there were over 20 complaints and multiple violations noted in the SDCI portal. Specific incidents, such as the failure to address no heat, bedbugs, faulty wiring, flooding, holes in floors and walls, and plumbing issues leading to severe property damage, highlight the inadequacy of self-certifications and the need for rigorous oversight. Notwithstanding the RRIO Program You suggested that your proactive random inspections are the reasons multiple violations and issues with these apartments have been found. While it is commendable that proactive inspections are being conducted, the historical data indicates that these measures are reactive rather than proactive. Here are critical points highlighting the failure to address ongoing issues: Historical Oversight Failures: The Lowell Emerson Apartments should have been subject to comprehensive inspections starting in 2014 due to the pre-existing violations. The failure to enforce these inspections allowed the property to remain in non-compliance for years. Lack of Effective Monitoring: The RRIO program's failure to enforce penalties and ensure compliance has allowed Metropolitan Management to continue violating

housing codes. The ongoing issues, such as lack of heat, hot water, and proper elevator maintenance, have persisted despite the supposed monitoring. Current State of Compliance: The requirement for 100% unit inspections in 2024 is a direct result of tenant pressure and not proactive enforcement. This reactive approach is insufficient to address the systemic issues at Lowell Emerson. Detailed Evidence and Additional Findings 1. Historical Complaints and Violations: 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025823...> 11/13 Prior to 2014, Lowell Emerson had received multiple violations

and emergency orders, which should have triggered more stringent inspection processes. Records show repeated admin closures of serious complaints without proper follow-up, such as complaint 002173-14CP, where the tenant had already moved out by the time SDCI attempted to address the issue. 2. Self-Certification Failures: Metropolitan

Management's repeated false self-certifications went unchallenged. For example, one notice of violation from March 2017 to the end of 2020 took three years to be resolved, during which time they falsely self-certified compliance despite over 20 complaints and multiple violations. Specific issues like no heat, bedbugs, faulty wiring, flooding, holes in floors and walls, and plumbing issues leading to severe property damage clearly indicate false certifications. 3. Proactive Inspections: While you mentioned proactive random inspections, historical data shows that these inspections were reactive to tenant pressure rather than proactive enforcement. The failure to address ongoing issues like lack of heat, hot water, and proper elevator maintenance demonstrates this reactive approach. 4. Systemic

Failures: The consistent withdrawal of violations and lack of follow-through on inspections highlights a systematic failure to enforce housing codes and protect tenants. The absence of transparency and accountability in handling violations and certifications undermines the RRIO program's effectiveness. Additional Concerns In your response, you mentioned that the RRIO enforcement lead has been in contact with the property owners and they are working towards compliance. Are you telling me, Jeff, that over a decade of substandard non-compliance and no penalties is acceptable? You are making it easy for them because acknowledging these failures would mean admitting that the SDCI did not do its job effectively. The RRIO program, in 2022, managed only 330 inspections out of 161,000 units. This number is shockingly low and demonstrates a lack of thorough enforcement. Math Breakdown: Inspecting only 330 out of 161,000 units equates to approximately 0.2%. This is unacceptable and highlights the significant gap in enforcement. Conclusion and Call to Action The ongoing failures of the SDCI to enforce the RRIO ordinance and ensure proper compliance by Metropolitan Management have resulted in prolonged substandard living conditions for tenants at the Lowell Emerson Apartments. The following points summarize the key failures: 1. Failure to Enforce Mandatory Inspections: Properties with multiple violations should have undergone thorough inspections starting in 2014. This was not done, allowing the property to remain in non-compliance. 2. False Self-Certifications: Repeated false certifications should have triggered immediate enforcement actions, including revocation of certifications and mandatory inspections. 3. Inadequate Response to Complaints: The pattern of withdrawing violations and not following through on inspections indicates a systematic failure to

address tenant complaints and enforce housing codes. 4. Lack of Accountability and Transparency: The records show a lack of transparency and accountability in handling violations and certifications, undermining the RRIO program's effectiveness. I urge you to take these concerns seriously and implement immediate corrective actions to ensure that the Lowell Emerson Apartments and other properties managed by Metropolitan Management are brought into compliance with housing codes. This includes conducting thorough inspections, enforcing penalties for non-compliance, and ensuring transparency in the certification process. Additionally, the self-certification should have been revoked due to the evident false certifications. This raises significant doubts about the validity of rental hikes and evictions that have occurred under these false pretenses. The properties are 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail - 1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025823...> 12/13 in disgusting, terrible conditions that have worsened over time due to the lack of proper maintenance. The 100% inspection should include all aspects of the building, such as plumbing, flooring, walls, and elevator compliance. The elevators have been operating without conveyance certificates for years, and the RRIO notices that should be given to tenants and posted visibly have never been provided. These failures demand revocation of certifications. The leniency in timeframes for a company like Metropolitan Management, with a portfolio over \$500 million, is unacceptable. They own Pacific West Construction and Maintenance, boasting about restoring vintage buildings and unit turns, yet they fail to maintain their own properties. This entire situation requires

a thorough investigation. The systematic breakdown within the SDCI is not about defending past actions but correcting them. I will be sharing my findings with the media and pursuing further action with the City Council and Ethics and Elections Commission. Thank you for your prompt attention to these critical matters. I look forward to seeing meaningful action taken to address these issues. Sincerely, Kimberly Coleman Lowell

Emerson Tenant Association sender notified by Mail Track for Gmail
[Quoted text hidden] Mailtrack Reminder Fri, Jul 5, 2024 at 2:26 PM

Reply-To: kevin.hou@seattle.gov, stephen.hinch@seattle.gov,
eric.jenkins@seattle.gov, geoff.tallent@seattle.gov,

scott.thiessen@seattle.gov To: kmcdm75@gmail.com 📧 You've not
received a reply yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H Mailtrack Reminder Sat,
Jul 6, 2024 at 10:25 AM Reply-To: geoff.tallent@seattle.gov,

kevin.hou@seattle.gov, stephen.hinch@seattle.gov,
eric.jenkins@seattle.gov, anissa.streb@seattle.gov,
chris.johanning@seattle.gov, scott.thiessen@seattle.gov To:

kmcdm75@gmail.com ⚠️ Your email to Geoff.Tallent@seattle.gov has not
been opened yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H (disable) Mailtrack
Reminder Mon, Jul 8, 2024 at 10:25 AM Reply-To:

geoff.tallent@seattle.gov, kevin.hou@seattle.gov,
stephen.hinch@seattle.gov, eric.jenkins@seattle.gov,
anissa.streb@seattle.gov, chris.johanning@seattle.gov,

scott.thiessen@seattle.gov To: kmcdm75@gmail.com 📧 You've not
received a reply yet. Snooze for 24H, 48H or 72H 3/6/25, 7:39 PM Gmail -
1110 8th Ave 006346-24CP

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/o/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all>

[&permthid=thread-f:1802157431025823816&simpl=msg-f:1802157431025823... 13/13](#)

From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections 7 messages From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Wed, Oct 30, 2024 at 4:14 PM To: "Streb, Anissa" Anissa, I am looking for the Inspection results of the inspections that took place on Oct 2nd and 9th. I cannot locate any record of them in the portal. Would you please forward the reports to me at your earliest convenience? Thank you, Kimberly Coleman Streb, Anissa Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:19 AM To: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Kimberly, Good Morning! I'm sorry but I was not the inspector on that inspection. I will pass on your request for information. Thank you. ANISSA STREB |HOUSING ZONING INSPECTOR Seale Department of Construcon & Inspecons | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seale, WA 98124-4019 P: 206-920-4137 | F: 206-615-1812 E: anissa.streb@seattle.gov Facebook | Twitter | Blog Helping people build a safe, livable, and inclusive Seale. 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020...> 1/8 SDCI offers most services online through our Virtual Applicant Services Center. For customers who need language assistance or technical assistance accessing the Virtual ASC, we have an SDCI informaon desk on the 4th floor of the Seale Municipal Tower. We offer limited access to our offices for scheduled public meengs. Get Outlook for iOS From: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Wednesday, October 30, 2024 4:14:47 PM To: Streb, Anissa Subject: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspecons CAUTION: External Email [Quoted text hidden] Schwartzenberger, Lisa Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:40 AM To: "kmcdm75@gmail.com" Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Hello Ms. Coleman, I am the Senior RRIO Inspector and Anissa forwarded me your email. The expanded RRIO inspections that were completed by myself and another inspector on October 2 nd & 9 th , did not include your unit, E402. Inspection results are sent to property management/ownership for repairs to be completed. If you would like a copy of the inspection results that do not include your unit, you may submit a public disclosure request to the City of Seattle. If you have any questions, or I can be of further assistance, please let me know. Lisa LISA SCHWARTZENBERGER | SENIOR RRIO/HOUSING ZONING INSPECTOR 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020>... 2/8 Seattle Department of

Construction & Inspections | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seattle, WA 98124-4019

P: 206-684-0984 | F: 206-615-1812 E: Lisa.Schwartzberger@seattle.gov

Facebook | X | Blog From: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Wednesday, October

30, 2024 4:15 PM To: Streb, Anissa Subject: Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

CAUTION: External Email Anissa, [Quoted text hidden] From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman

Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 1:15 PM To: "Schwartzberger, Lisa" Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Hi Lisa, It's nice

to hear from you again. Thank you for your prompt response. Yes, I am aware that the

inspection did not end up including my unit E402, which raises my question, could you please

explain why the planned 100% property inspections on October 2nd and 9th were not

completed. What was the deviation that hindered the planned 100% property inspection? I'm

also very concerned, given the evidence of discrepancies, about Metropolitan Management's

ongoing falsification of self-certification, which seems to have been happening for over a

decade. Given SDCI's authority to penalize and revoke registrations for such RRIO violations,

what actions will be taken across all Metropolitan Management properties? Specifically: Is SDCI

using its full authority to ensure all Metropolitan Management properties meet minimum

housing code standards? 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO

inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020>... 3/8 Will all Metropolitan Management

properties receive a comprehensive 100% inspection, given the continued pattern of

self-certifying despite ongoing issues? How is SDCI addressing this situation to enforce RRIO

standards, ensure tenant safety, and hold Metropolitan Management accountable for false

certifications? Thank you for addressing these urgent concerns. oh, one more question, Anissa

worked on this complaint so maybe she can help bring clarity to the issue. Reference: Record

Number: 001065-23CP (HOUSING - PRE.REG. #001-0146962) Duplicate Reference: Record

Number: 000897-23CP Record #000897-23CP is marked as a duplicate and references record,

001065-23, which, in turn, references pre-registration #001-0146962. My question concerns the

pre-registration number associated with this record, as I am unable to find any correlation

between this number and the property in question within the RRIO system. My understanding is

that RRIO pre-registration numbers are issued specifically to properties upon their registration

in the RRIO system. However, searching for this particular property yields no indication of its

RRIO registration, and it appears that the associated duplicate record is not for this property at

all but rather references a completely separate location. Could you please clarify: 1. Why was this property assigned an RRIO pre-registration number (#001-0146962) in the notes when it does not appear registered with RRIO? 2. How complaints from tenants associated with this property were handled without a formal RRIO registration? I'm trying to understand why there was no flag raised in response to a complaint for a property that lacks a current RRIO registration and why this pre-registration number is referenced in the absence of official RRIO records. Thank you both for your time. Kimberly Coleman [Quoted text hidden]

Schwartzenger, Lisa Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 1:54 PM To: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Cc: "Streb, Anissa" 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020...> 4/8 Hello, To clarify, the inspections

conducted on October 2 nd and 9 th were part of an expanded RRIO inspection. Expanded inspections mean the property's initial RRIO inspections failed and additional units were selected for inspection, per the Ordinance. I would encourage you to review the Rental Registration Inspection Ordinance (22.214). The Ordinance specifically outlines the process in which rental properties will be chosen for inspection. Please refer to 22.214.050 (G) (3) for explanation of the expanded RRIO process, to explain why not all of the units were not inspected on the October dates. As for Metropolitan Management's properties, all properties registered with the RRIO program will follow the selection process as specified in the Ordinance. We will conduct inspections once a property is randomly selected. Once chosen, the property will be inspected to protect the health, safety and welfare of the tenants residing at the property. SDCI will determine if any RRIO registration certifications were falsely made. As for you question to Anissa regarding a pre-registration number, please be aware that a pre-registration number that is attached to a housing complaint is for internal purposes only. The properties at LowellEmerson are registered with the RRIO program, information which is available on the Seattle Services Portal. If a housing complaint is received by SDCI, we will schedule and complete a housing inspection following the Housing Building Maintenance Code (HBMC) and not the RRIO checklist. Please note that these are two different types of inspections our inspectors conduct. A property owner is able to hire a private inspector to conduct their RRIO inspection whereas only City of Seattle inspectors can conduct an HBMC housing inspection. I understand your frustration with your property management company, however please know we are working diligently with them to improve housing conditions at Lowell-Emerson and that they are working very hard to come into compliance. [Quoted text

hidden] [Quoted text hidden] [Quoted text hidden] From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 2:18 PM To: "Schwartzenger, Lisa" Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Lisa, Thank you for your response. I understand the expanded RRIO inspection process as outlined in Ordinance 22.214. However, my concern goes beyond the specific RRIO procedures or the compliance of my landlord. The issue here is SDCI's accountability in 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020...> 5/8 enforcing the ordinance and

ensuring that properties are genuinely compliant with Seattle's rental standards—something that the department has consistently overlooked. While I understand that RRIO inspections may be selective, the systemic gaps in enforcement raise significant questions. For instance, there was no flag raised when SDCI's inspectors encountered a rental property lacking proper registration in the RRIO system. This is not about one record number or inspection result; it's about whether SDCI actively enforces the ordinance and fulfills its responsibility to tenants across the city. I would appreciate it if we could address the following points directly: 1.

Accountability for Non-Compliance: How does SDCI ensure that RRIO violations by property managers are adequately investigated, particularly when there are ongoing issues with false certifications? 2. Clear Enforcement Standards: Beyond selecting properties at random, what measures are in place to guarantee that RRIO requirements are upheld for all

properties—especially when non-compliance is observed? Thank you for acknowledging these broader concerns. It's crucial that SDCI prioritizes tenant safety through a proactive

enforcement approach, as outlined in the ordinance. Best regards, Kimberly Coleman [Quoted

text hidden] Schwartzenger, Lisa Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 2:34 PM To: From The Desk Of

Kimberly Coleman Cc: "Streb, Anissa" Please see responses below to your questions. I

understand you have many concerns, but all information regarding the execution of the RRIO

program can be found in the RRIO Ordinance. That is the code in which we follow and all

processes are outlined very clearly. Some of your questions appear to be about property

management, and we do not oversee property management in the City of Seattle. Our job is to

enforce the RRIO ordinance and the Housing Building Maintenance Code. If you are having

issues with your property management I would encourage to reach out to an attorney or

contact 211 for more resources to assist you. Lisa 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson

Apartments RRIO inspections

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?ik=d984f87109&view=pt&search=all&permthid=thread-a:r9072213401986407455&simpl=msg-a:r322784710669020...> 6/8 LISA SCHWARTZENBERGER |

SENIOR RRIO/HOUSING ZONING INSPECTOR Seattle Department of Construction & Inspections | Code Compliance P.O. Box 34019, Seattle, WA 98124-4019 P: 206-684-0984 | F: 206-615-1812 E: Lisa.Schwartzberger@seattle.gov

Facebook | X | Blog From: From The Desk Of Kimberly Coleman Sent: Thursday, October 31, 2024 2:18 PM To: Schwartzberger, Lisa Cc: Streb, Anissa Subject: Re: Lowell Emerson

Apartments RRIO inspections Lisa, Thank you for your response. I understand the expanded RRIO inspection process as outlined in Ordinance 22.214. However, my concern goes beyond the specific RRIO procedures or the compliance of my landlord. The issue here is SDCI's accountability in enforcing the ordinance and ensuring that properties are genuinely compliant with Seattle's rental standards —something that the department has consistently overlooked.

While I understand that RRIO inspections may be selective, the systemic gaps in enforcement raise significant questions. For instance, there was no flag raised when SDCI's inspectors encountered a rental property lacking proper registration in the RRIO system. This is not about one record number or inspection result; it's about whether SDCI actively enforces the ordinance and fulfills its responsibility to tenants across the city. I would appreciate it if we could address the following points directly: 1. Accountability for Non-Compliance: How does SDCI ensure that RRIO violations by property managers are adequately 3/6/25, 7:42 PM Gmail - Lowell Emerson Apartments RRIO inspections.

Tab 4

Tab 5

Key Points

- It seems likely that the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI) has systemic failures in rental housing oversight, including neglect, corruption, and data manipulation.
 - Research suggests the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA) could address these issues with an independent structure, potentially costing \$20 million annually.
 - The evidence leans toward STLCA needing divisions for inspections, complaint handling, enforcement, policy, and administration, led by a Director/CEO.
 - Case studies like Lowell Emerson Apartments and Everspring Inn highlight SDCI's inadequate response, supporting the need for STLCA.
-

Audit Report: Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA)

Introduction

This audit report assesses the current state of rental housing oversight in Seattle, focusing on the performance of the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI). Based on extensive analysis of complaint data, reports, and case studies, it proposes the establishment of the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA) as an independent body to address identified issues. The report includes details on STLCA's organizational structure, budget, and supporting case studies in the appendix.

Findings: Systemic Failures of SDCI

Through my research, I found significant issues with SDCI's oversight of rental housing, including:

- **Neglect and Corruption:** SDCI has failed to enforce housing standards, ignoring thousands of tenant complaints about critical issues like no heat, water, or electricity, mold, infestations, structural damage, and fire hazards. Many complaints are dismissed or closed without investigation, with some violations unresolved for over five years.

- **Data Manipulation & Record Tampering:** SDCI manipulates records, such as fabricating pre-registration data for the Rental Registration and Inspection Ordinance (RRIO) program and altering the Last Inspection Date field to store geographic coordinates, obscuring accountability and making it impossible to track inspection timelines.
- **Nepotism and Conflicts of Interest:** Documented cases, like the Lunde Family Scandal, show SDCI officials and their relatives owning properties that receive preferential treatment, avoiding enforcement actions despite violations.
- **Violations of Tenant Safety & Rights:** Case studies reveal SDCI's failure to protect tenants, with illegal evictions, unaddressed habitability issues, and inadequate enforcement of safety codes, endangering tenant health and safety.
- **Financial Negligence:** SDCI has failed to collect millions in fines, misusing tenant protection funds and underfunding enforcement while favoring landlord-friendly policies.

Proposed Solution: STLCA

To address these failures, I propose the creation of the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA), an independent body to oversee rental housing. The structure and budget are as follows:

Organizational Structure

STLCA's proposed structure includes:

- **Director/CEO:** Oversees strategic direction and overall management.
- **Inspection Division:** Conducts proactive inspections to ensure compliance, addressing the current backlog.
- **Complaint Handling Division:** Manages real-time complaint tracking for efficient resolution, ending self-certification fraud.
- **Enforcement Division:** Enforces regulations through legal actions against non-compliant landlords.
- **Policy and Planning Division:** Develops and implements policies to improve housing oversight.

- **Finance and Administration Division:** Manages financial resources and administrative functions.

This structure aims to ensure transparency and accountability, potentially a significant shift from SDCI's broader scope.

Budget

The estimated annual budget for STLCA is **\$20 million**, with funding sources detailed in the table below:

Funding Source	Amount (\$ million)	Details
Reallocated SDCI Funds	10	Funds from SDCI's rental housing oversight functions, estimated based on scope.
JumpStart Payroll Expense Tax	10	Leveraged from the tax generating approximately \$430 million annually in 2025 (City Finance).

This budget reflects the need for enhanced staffing and technology, such as real-time complaint tracking systems, and is based on the assumption that STLCA would take over specific oversight functions from SDCI.

Case Studies Supporting Findings

The appendix includes detailed case studies to support the audit's findings:

- **Lowell Emerson Apartments:** Complaints from 2008 to 2024 show recurring issues like no hot water, sewage leaks, broken elevators, and pest infestations, with many closed without inspection, highlighting SDCI's neglect.

- **Everspring Inn:** Illegal evictions during the COVID-19 pandemic, chronic safety hazards, and unresolved complaints illustrate SDCI's failure to protect tenants, exacerbating vulnerabilities.

These case studies provide concrete evidence for the need for STLCA, showing real-world impacts of SDCI's inefficiencies.

Conclusion

Based on my analysis, SDCI's systemic failures necessitate the creation of STLCA to restore trust and ensure effective oversight of rental housing in Seattle. The proposed structure and budget offer a viable path forward, addressing the current crisis and protecting tenant rights.

Survey Note: Comprehensive Analysis of STLCA Audit and Implementation

This section provides a detailed examination of the audit report for the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA), including its rationale, proposed structure, budget, and supporting case studies. The analysis is based on a comprehensive review of provided documents and supplementary research, ensuring a thorough understanding for stakeholders and policymakers.

Background and Context

The need for an audit stems from systemic failures within the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI), as detailed in the report "The Price of Inaction: The Case for Independent Oversight in Seattle's Rental Housing" dated February 2025. This report, along with additional data on complaints and violations, underscores SDCI's inefficiencies in managing rental housing oversight. Key issues include unresolved tenant complaints, data manipulation, corruption, and financial negligence, necessitating the creation of STLCA as an independent oversight body.

The report highlights SDCI's failure to protect tenant safety, with specific examples of negligence such as ignored habitability violations and a massive backlog of cases. It also exposes

data manipulation, such as altering the Last Inspection Date field to store unrelated data, and systemic corruption, including the Lunde family scandal involving nepotism. Financially, SDCI's inability to collect fines has cost the city millions, underfunding tenant protections while favoring landlords.

Audit Report Structure and Findings

The audit report is structured to provide a clear assessment of SDCI's operations, with the following findings:

1. Systemic Failures in Housing Oversight:

- SDCI has a pattern of negligence, with 26,676 unresolved code compliance complaints, including critical issues like fire hazards and mold, as noted in the PDF attachment.
- Tenant complaints are often deprioritized, with cases closed without inspections, leaving tenants in unsafe conditions such as water damage and structural hazards.

2. Data Manipulation and Record Tampering:

- The report details SDCI's manipulation of records, including fabricated pre-registration records in the RRIO program, with no audit trails to ensure accountability.
- The PDF attachment specifically mentions the Last Inspection Date field being used for geographic coordinates, hindering performance tracking.

3. Systemic Corruption:

- Nepotism and conflicts of interest are evident, with the Lunde family scandal illustrating preferential treatment for relatives of SDCI employees.
- Permitting irregularities and rapid compliance resolutions suggest bias, undermining tenant protections.

4. **Violations of Tenant Safety and Rights:**

- Tenants face health hazards like mold and exposed wiring, with SDCI failing to enforce penalties, as seen in case studies like Lowell Emerson Apartments and Everspring Inn.
- Illegal evictions, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic, highlight SDCI's disregard for tenant rights, exacerbating vulnerabilities.

5. **Portal Manipulation Scandal:**

- SDCI manipulated its complaint portal by altering timestamps and removing violations, further obscuring accountability and eroding public trust.

6. **Financial Negligence:**

- The failure to collect fines has cost Seattle millions, with underfunding of tenant protections while landlord-friendly programs receive priority, as noted in the report's financial analysis.

These findings collectively justify the need for STLCA, proposed as a solution to restore trust and ensure compliance through independent oversight.

Proposed Organizational Structure of STLCA

The organizational structure of STLCA is designed to address SDCI's shortcomings, ensuring proactive and transparent operations. Based on the report's recommendations, the structure includes:

- **Director/CEO:** Oversees strategic direction and overall management, ensuring alignment with city goals.

- **Inspection Division:** Conducts proactive inspections to ensure compliance with housing standards, addressing the current backlog and negligence.
- **Complaint Handling Division:** Manages real-time complaint tracking, providing efficient resolution and ending self-certification fraud, a key issue identified in the report.
- **Enforcement Division:** Enforces regulations through legal actions against non-compliant landlords, enhancing accountability.
- **Policy and Planning Division:** Develops and implements policies to improve housing oversight, focusing on transparency and tenant protections.
- **Finance and Administration Division:** Manages financial resources and administrative functions, ensuring sustainable operations.

This structure aims to create a robust, independent body, potentially a significant shift compared to SDCI's broader scope.

Budget Analysis

The budget for STLCA is estimated at \$20 million annually, with funding sources as follows:

Funding Source	Amount (\$ million)	Details
Reallocated SDCI Funds	10	Funds from SDCI's rental housing oversight functions, estimated based on scope.
JumpStart Payroll Expense Tax	10	Leveraged from the tax generating approximately \$430 million annually in 2025 (City Finance).

The JumpStart Payroll Expense Tax, implemented in 2021, supports affordable housing and other city services, with 2025 revenue expected to reach \$430 million ([Axios Seattle](#)). The reallocation from SDCI is based on the assumption that STLCA would take over specific

oversight functions, estimated at \$10 million given SDCI's broader budget context, though exact figures are not detailed in the attachments.

This budget reflects the need for enhanced staffing and technology, such as real-time complaint tracking systems, potentially a significant investment compared to SDCI's historical spending.

Case Studies for the Appendix

The appendix includes detailed case studies to support the audit findings, drawn from the attachments:

1. Lowell Emerson Apartments:

- **Description of Issues:** The Excel file details complaints from 2008 to 2024, including lack of hot water, sewage leaks, elevator malfunctions, pest infestations, and management negligence. Specific issues include elevators out of service, unsafe conditions, and lack of certification, impacting resident safety.
- **SDCI's Response:** The data shows many complaints closed without inspections, with no effective enforcement, highlighting systemic neglect.

2. Everspring Inn:

- **Description of Issues:** The report notes illegal evictions during the COVID-19 pandemic, chronic safety hazards like mold and exposed wiring, and unresolved tenant complaints, exacerbating tenant vulnerabilities.
- **SDCI's Response:** SDCI failed to enforce penalties or protect tenants, with cases left unresolved, illustrating the need for independent oversight.

These case studies provide concrete evidence, ensuring the audit's recommendations are grounded in real-world examples.

Implementation Considerations

The implementation of STLCA requires defunding SDCI's oversight role and reallocating budgets, as suggested in Chapter 9 of the report. Legal and policy recommendations include mandating external audits and strict enforcement timelines, supported by tenant advocacy groups. The funding strategy leverages JumpStart tax revenues, potentially controversial given competing city priorities, but essential for addressing housing crises.

Conclusion

This comprehensive analysis supports the audit report's findings, proposing STLCA as a critical step to address SDCI's failures. The detailed structure, budget, and case studies ensure a robust framework for independent oversight, aligning with the city's 2025 priorities for housing affordability and tenant protections.

Key Citations

- [The Price of Inaction: The Case for Independent Oversight in Seattle's Rental Housing](#)
- [Systemic Failures and Inefficiencies within SDCI](#)
- [Complaints and Violations Data for Lowell Emerson Apartments](#)
- [City Finance Seattle Taxes Payroll Expense Tax](#)
- [Axios Seattle City Council Jumpstart Tax Budget](#)

Tab 6

Key Points

- It seems likely that the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI) has systemic failures in rental housing oversight, including neglect, corruption, and data manipulation.
- Research suggests the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA) could address these issues with an independent structure, potentially costing \$20 million annually.
- The evidence leans toward STLCA needing divisions for inspections, complaint handling, enforcement, policy, and administration, led by a Director/CEO.
- Case studies like Lowell Emerson Apartments and Everspring Inn highlight SDCI's inadequate response, supporting the need for STLCA.

Introduction

This section provides a summary of the audit findings for the proposed Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA), addressing the current failures of the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI) in rental housing oversight. It outlines the proposed structure, budget, and case studies to support the establishment of STLCA.

Findings

- SDCI has failed to enforce housing standards, with 26,676 unresolved complaints, including critical issues like no heat, water, and mold.
- Data manipulation, such as altering the Last Inspection Date field, obscures accountability and shields violators.
- Nepotism cases, like the Lunde family scandal, show preferential treatment for certain landlords.
- Tenants face unsafe conditions, with illegal evictions and unresolved complaints, as seen in case studies.
- Financial negligence, with millions in uncollected fines, underfunds tenant protections.

Proposed Solution

- STLCA's structure includes a Director/CEO and divisions for inspections, complaint handling, enforcement, policy, and administration.

- The estimated annual budget is \$20 million, with \$10 million from reallocated SDCI funds and \$10 million from the JumpStart Payroll Expense Tax ([City Finance](#)).

Unexpected Detail

- The budget estimate of \$20 million is higher than SDCI's current \$9.2 million for similar programs, reflecting the need for enhanced oversight, which might be unexpected given the city's recent budget cuts.

Comprehensive Analysis of STLCA Audit and Implementation

This section provides a detailed examination of the audit report for the Seattle Tenants-Landlords Compliance Authority (STLCA), including its rationale, proposed structure, budget, and supporting case studies. The analysis is based on a comprehensive review of provided documents and supplementary research, ensuring a thorough understanding for stakeholders and policymakers.

Background and Context

The need for an audit stems from systemic failures within the Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI), as detailed in the report "The Price of Inaction: The Case for Independent Oversight in Seattle's Rental Housing" dated February 2025. This report, along with additional data on complaints and violations, underscores SDCI's inefficiencies in managing rental housing oversight. Key issues include unresolved tenant complaints, data manipulation, corruption, and financial negligence, necessitating the creation of STLCA as an independent oversight body.

The report highlights SDCI's failure to protect tenant safety, with specific examples of negligence such as ignored habitability violations and a massive backlog of cases. It also exposes data manipulation, such as altering the Last Inspection Date field to store unrelated data, and systemic corruption, including the Lunde family scandal involving nepotism. Financially, SDCI's inability to collect fines has cost the city millions, underfunding tenant protections while favoring landlords.

Audit Report Structure and Findings

The audit report is structured to provide a clear assessment of SDCI's operations, with the following findings:

1. Systemic Failures in Housing Oversight:

- SDCI has a pattern of negligence, with 26,676 unresolved code compliance complaints, including critical issues like fire hazards and mold, as noted in the PDF attachment.
- Tenant complaints are often deprioritized, with cases closed without inspections, leaving tenants in unsafe conditions such as water damage and structural hazards.

2. Data Manipulation and Record Tampering:

- The report details SDCI's manipulation of records, including fabricated pre-registration records in the RRIO program, with no audit trails to ensure accountability.
- The PDF attachment specifically mentions the Last Inspection Date field being used for geographic coordinates, hindering performance tracking.

3. Systemic Corruption:

- Nepotism and conflicts of interest are evident, with the Lunde family scandal illustrating preferential treatment for relatives of SDCI employees.
- Permitting irregularities and rapid compliance resolutions suggest bias, undermining tenant protections.

4. Violations of Tenant Safety and Rights:

- Tenants face health hazards like mold and exposed wiring, with SDCI failing to enforce penalties, as seen in case studies like Lowell Emerson Apartments and Everspring Inn.
- Illegal evictions, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic, highlight SDCI's disregard for tenant rights, exacerbating vulnerabilities.

5. **Portal Manipulation Scandal:**

- SDCI manipulated its complaint portal by altering timestamps and removing violations, further obscuring accountability and eroding public trust.

6. **Financial Negligence:**

- The failure to collect fines has cost Seattle millions, with underfunding of tenant protections while landlord-friendly programs receive priority, as noted in the report's financial analysis.

These findings collectively justify the need for STLCA, proposed as a solution to restore trust and ensure compliance through independent oversight.

Proposed Organizational Structure of STLCA

The organizational structure of STLCA is designed to address SDCI's shortcomings, ensuring proactive and transparent operations. Based on the report's recommendations, the structure includes:

- **Director/CEO:** Oversees strategic direction and overall management, ensuring alignment with city goals.
- **Inspection Division:** Conducts proactive inspections to ensure compliance with housing standards, addressing the current backlog and negligence.
- **Complaint Handling Division:** Manages real-time complaint tracking, providing efficient resolution and ending self-certification fraud, a key issue identified in the report.

- **Enforcement Division:** Enforces regulations through legal actions against non-compliant landlords, enhancing accountability.
- **Policy and Planning Division:** Develops and implements policies to improve housing oversight, focusing on transparency and tenant protections.
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This structure aims to create a robust, independent body, potentially a significant shift compared to SDCI's broader scope.

Budget Analysis

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This budget reflects the need for enhanced staffing and technology, such as real-time complaint tracking systems, potentially a significant investment compared to SDCI's historical spending.

Case Studies for the Appendix

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- **Description of Issues:** The Excel file details complaints from 2008 to 2024, including lack of hot water, sewage leaks, elevator malfunctions, pest infestations, and management negligence. Specific issues include elevators out of service, unsafe conditions, and lack of certification, impacting resident safety.
- **SDCI's Response:** The data shows many complaints closed without inspections, with no effective enforcement, highlighting systemic neglect.

2. Everspring Inn:

- **Description of Issues:** The report notes illegal evictions during the COVID-19 pandemic, chronic safety hazards like mold and exposed wiring, and unresolved tenant complaints, exacerbating tenant vulnerabilities.
- **SDCI's Response:** SDCI failed to enforce penalties or protect tenants, with cases left unresolved, illustrating the need for independent oversight.

These case studies provide concrete evidence, ensuring the audit's recommendations are grounded in real-world examples.

Implementation Considerations

The implementation of STLCA requires defunding SDCI's oversight role and reallocating budgets, as suggested in Chapter 9 of the report. Legal and policy recommendations include mandating external audits and strict enforcement timelines, supported by tenant advocacy groups. The funding strategy leverages JumpStart tax revenues, potentially controversial given competing city priorities, but essential for addressing housing crises.

Conclusion

This comprehensive analysis supports the audit report's findings, proposing STLCA as a critical step to address SDCI's failures. The detailed structure, budget, and case studies ensure a robust framework for independent oversight, aligning with the city's 2025 priorities for housing affordability and tenant protections.

Key Citations

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